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OMAR CHACON: *TITLE*
September 9 – October 23, 2021

Margaret Thatcher Projects is pleased to present *TITLE*, an exhibition of new paintings and works on paper by Omar Chacon. Opening on Thursday, September 9, and continuing through Saturday, October 23, 2021, this will be the artist's fifth solo exhibition at the gallery.

Omar Chacon's lustrous abstract paintings are constructed in layers from small, colorful paint elements affixed to canvas or paper. From afar, the paintings glimmer with an alluring sheen and a mix of vivid and subdued hues. Closer inspection reveals surfaces studded with a multitude of individual drips, drops, or irregular tiles, each containing striations of vibrant acrylic. Chacon's paintings suggest woven fabrics, mosaics of glass tile, or enamel *cloisonné*, yet they are distinguished by lively imperfections, a joyous spirit of generosity, and a notion of cross-cultural exchange.

Based on the confluence of his Columbian heritage and experiences living in the U.S., Chacon is inspired by the connections between individuals within large, diverse communities. He conveys this sense of vital interrelation in his paintings through compositional strategies, color placement, and chance associations. For example, the works on canvas in this exhibition contain slightly meandering grids of small rectangular tiles. Each tile is unique in its wavering color combinations, and as rows of tiles jog across the surface, their differences and similarities are resolved in an overall orchestration. Alternately, in one work on paper, the palette range is mostly restricted to shades of purple, but the energy of hundreds of drips cascades down the sheet as if following the flow of an invisible magnetic field. In another work on paper, a dark ground is interspersed with tiny blobs of intense, multihued color that suggest a vast, yet welcoming, cosmos.

Chacon's paintings are both exuberantly abundant and carefully balanced. They reflect his careful study of color theory as well as his interest in connections between individuals, family narratives, indigenous traditions, Central and South American history, geography, and community. His work reminds viewers that each individual gesture --colorful, bold, subtle, unexpected, or part of a sequence-- is reliant on all the others to form a flourishing network.

Omar Chacon was born in Bogota, Colombia. He received his MFA from the San Francisco Art Institute, CA and his BFA from the Ringling College of Art and Design, FL. His work has been exhibited nationally and internationally in cities such as Los Angeles, Milan, San Francisco and Mexico City. Chacon has participated in exhibitions at the Children's Museum of the Arts in New York, NY and the Mobile Museum of Art in Mobile, AL. In 2009, Chacon was selected as part of the Queens International Four at the 2009 Biennial at the Queens Museum of Art, New York. He is the recipient of numerous awards including the 2007 William and Dorothy Yeck Award through the Miami University National Young Painters Competition and the 2008 New York Foundation for the Arts Fellowship. His paintings have been reviewed in *Art & Antiques*, *Artnet*, *Art in America* and *Artweek Magazine*, among others.

Margaret Thatcher Projects is located at 539 West 23rd Street, ground floor (between 10th and 11th Avenues). Gallery hours are Tuesday through Saturday from 11 am to 6 pm. For further information contact the gallery at: info@thatcherprojects.com, or 212.675.0222.